

YUKA

Phase 3: Features, Prioritization + PRD

Brainstorm · Prioritize · Prototype · Metrics · Pitfalls

What YUKA Does

A mobile app that allows people to quickly check if a food or cosmetic product is healthy and safe for them by letting them scan the product and providing a score based on multiple factors such as nutritional value, presence of additives, hazardous chemicals, and more.

Section 01 — Brainstorm Solution

P0 :

Health conscious/General wellness focused users are finding the scores are misleading as some products that they know that are 'healthy' for them are poorly scored and vice versa (**example:** ' toasted sunflower seeds snack ', scoring '**poor**' as its high on fats,calories but those are good fats for some,some don't mind more calories, salt .'Kellogg's cereals' scored '**excellent**' because its low on calories and doesn't have additives , but some users are concerned that they are ultra-processed food and nutritionally thin,so it shouldn't be scoring 'excellent') . This lack of contextual scoring leads to confusion and reduces trust in the app. They don't go for conversion as they are not happy with 'basic' scoring and use the app only for 'additives' checking, this affects revenue as it reduces conversion. If this is not addressed, it could gradually reduce engagement and affect retention in future.

Root Causes :

- Oversimplification of scoring
- Disregarding individual needs
- Failure to provide details on some key factors that determine if a product is healthy such as food processing levels, presence of microplastics which are of concern for most health conscious consumers

Solution	Short Description	Key Assumption	Category
Indicate Food Processing level	Extend existing product details pane to show food processing levels	Users can make informed decision based on processing levels than getting confused as to why are certain processed foods scoring high on the app.	HIGH CONFIDENCE
Disregarding individual needs	Create customised profiles for users ,include factors beyond diet preferences and provide notifications for those needs	When users are given the power to customise beyond basic diet preferences and are able to get the alerts as per their unique needs or health goals,they will trust the app more as the alerts will be more relevant for them.This would help users make confident choices .	HIGH CONFIDENCE
Access Health Metrics from connected devices/applications	Access users health metrics/goals from their android or apple health hubs and provide contextual dynamic scoring based on those parameters	This dynamic and personalised scoring will be more user data driven as the scores will be tied to their current status of their key health parameters and goals.	MOONSHOT

Over Simplificaiton of scoring	Intelligent Scoring algorithm that considers user's diet, how is product processed/cooked, frequency of consumption, and individual needs such as their health goal, food preferences and provide contextual scoring for users	This would be more accurate for users than presenting generic scores and will drive long term user retention. Users will also start seeing this as a well rounded contextual nutrition app rather than a generic food scanning app. This is also inline with the app's long term vision.	MOONSHOT
Provide detailed Clarification on scoring	Provide an AI agent/chatbot that can quickly clarify scoring of a particular food item for the user	This will help the users understand the rationale behind scores for a particular food item or similar food items that have different scores, on the go by querying the AI agent as opposed to figuring it out themselves. This can improve both trust and transparency of scoring rationale to the user.	HIGH CONFIDENCE
Present hazards associated with ingredients	Presenting health impacts of key ingredients in an easily accessible dashboard	In addition to negatives and positives about ingredients, presenting health hazards or risks that were taken into account while scoring in an easily accessible dashboard will give a well rounded perspective of the score associated with a particular food item.	HIGH CONFIDENCE

Section 02 — Prioritization

SOLUTION	REACH	IMPACT	CONF	EFFORT	RICE SCORE	NOTES
Indicate Food Processing level	3	3	3	2	13.5	Reaches all users, higher confidence based on qualitative user feedback
Customization for individual needs	2	3	3	2	9	easy to build based on existing

						platform features, strong evidence for the need from platform analysis and user surveys but could be offered only for members
Access Health Metrics from connected devices/applications	1	3	2	3	2	Moonshot feature which relies on integrating with phone's health ecosystem and targeted towards niche audience
Over Simplification of scoring	2	3	2	3	4	Changes core scoring capability and could be idea for future
Provide Clarification on scoring	3	2	3	2	9	Reduces user friction in understanding scores, resulting in better clarity and relatively easier to implement
Present hazards associated with ingredients	3	1	2	1	6	Low impact and can make some users overwhelmed with more detailed health hazard information

Section 03 — Make Your Solution Real

YUKA prototype app - <https://ai.studio/apps/59949c46-84d6-479c-bcdc-9c97b44b3b96>

Section 04 — Success Metrics

Phase 2 goal
Improve Retention for health-conscious, general wellness users.

P0 Problem Statement :
Health conscious/General wellness focused users are finding the scores are misleading as some products that they know are 'healthy' for them are poorly scored and vice versa (**example:** ' toasted sunflower seeds snack ', scoring '**poor**' as its high on fats, salt and 'Kellog's cereals' scoring '**excellent**' just because its low on calories and doesn't have additives) . This lack of contextual scoring leads to confusion and reduces trust in the app. They don't go for conversion as they are not happy with 'basic' scoring and use the app only for 'additives' checking, this affects revenue as it reduces conversion. If this is not addressed, it could gradually reduce engagement and affect retention in future.

P0 Solution :
Indicate 'Food Processing' level as it's a key factor that most users are concerned about when deciding if a product is healthy or not and provide clarification on scoring ,so that users can easily understand the rationale behind scoring than feeling annoyed as to why certain scores are inaccurate

METRIC TYPE	METRIC NAME	DEFINITION	WHY IT MATTERS
KEY METRIC	Quarterly rate of retention	% of existing users retained every quarter	It measures if existing free tier users are using the product consistently and if it increases after the 'food processing' levels,AI scoring is implemented
SECONDARY METRIC	Click rate of ingredient details pane	% users click ingredient details pane	Increase in this % Shows the number of users who click 'ingredient details' pane to check the food processing levels displayed (note: this is on the assumption that only this feature is going Live and existing features remain the same for that period of time ,so it's a clear indicator that this feature drove the metric)

	Click rate of AI assistant for score clarification	% of users who click AI chat for score clarification	Shows if users are actively using this feature to clarify their concerns or questions about scores given by YUKA
	Avg No Likes per week	Avg No Likes per week	Shows if AI response is satisfactory
	Membership conversion rate	% of users who had actively engaged with AI assistant and got converted to Members	Indicates users feel more confident with the explanations of app's scoring and want to customize the app further for their specific goals, leading to upgrade
GUARDRAIL	Avg products scanned per user	% of existing users not scanning as much as before	Shows that these features have mislead them and have not been useful, so they disengage

Section 05 — Identify Pitfalls & Mitigations

ASSUMPTION AT RISK	FAILURE MODE	IMPACT	LIKELIHOOD	MITIGATION	DETECTION SIGNAL	CONTAINMENT
Users will view the 'food processing' levels slider	Users don't scroll for ingredients details to check food processing levels	HIGH	MEDIUM	Targeted survey of Beta users to check if they saw the food processing details on ingredients view	Survey response indicating users not visibly noticing the processing levels	Visual indication of processing levels along with scores; Alert users about this new feature for first 3 months
Users want to view food processing slider by default	Users are overwhelmed with additional details	HIGH	LOW-MED	Make this a simpler dropdown pane that is not displayed by default and shown only if they click	Low click rates of ingredient details pane as they are confused due to more details displayed	Come up with simpler visual icons to indicate processing levels
Users will find AI assistant extremely helpful to	They are annoyed by AI chat assistant's responses and	HIGH	MED	Make AI chat more intuitive than providing generic responses which users can see	Less adoption of AI assistant and low engagement rate once AI chat is initiated	Offer additional email support (responded by YUKA team) for

understand product scores	don't prefer to share their questions with an AI agent			themselves on screen		unsatisfied users
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